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MySQL DEFAULT Constraint

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MySQL DEFAULT Constraint

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The `DEFAULT` constraint is used to automatically insert a default value for a column, if no value is specified.

The default value will be added to all new records (if no other value is specified).

DEFAULT Constraint on CREATE TABLE

The following SQL sets a `DEFAULT` value for the "City" column upon creation of the "Persons" table:

```
CREATE TABLE Persons (
    ID int PRIMARY KEY,
    LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
```

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The `DEFAULT` constraint can also be used to insert system values, by using functions like `CURRENT_DATE()` to insert the current date:

```
CREATE TABLE Orders (
    ID int PRIMARY KEY,
    OrderNumber int NOT NULL,
    OrderDate date DEFAULT CURRENT_DATE()
);
```

DEFAULT Constraint on ALTER TABLE

To define a `DEFAULT` constraint on the "City" column when the table is already created, use the following SQL:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
ALTER City SET DEFAULT 'Sandnes';
```

DROP a DEFAULT Constraint

To drop a `DEFAULT` constraint, use the following SQL:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
ALTER City DROP DEFAULT;
```

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Exercise

What is the primary purpose of the SQL `DEFAULT` constraint?

- To ensure all values in a column are unique
- To set a default value for a column when no value is specified
- To limit the range of values in a column
- To prevent NULL values in a column

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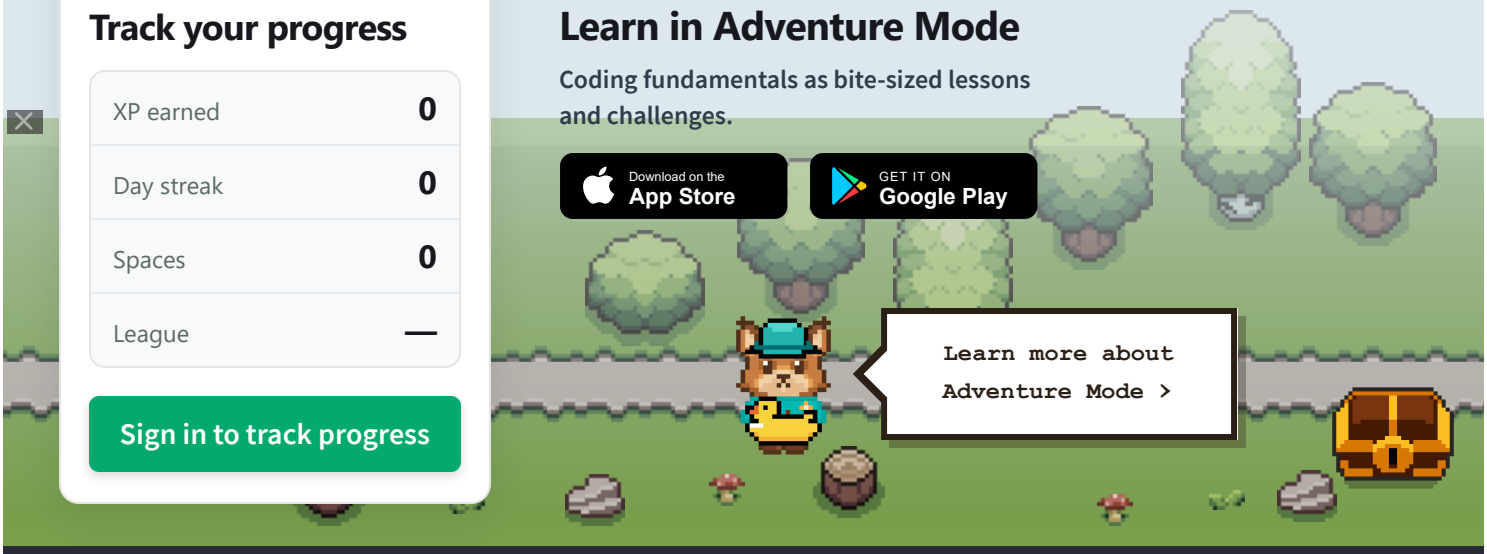
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